Notes

Introduction

1 No history books of N.C.E.R.T. (till matriculation) ever elaborated the lives of revolutionaries. It was my fortune to be a student of D.A.V. Public School where specifically the *Dharam Shiksha* books dealt with individual chapters on people like Ram Prasad Bismil, Lala Har Dayal Mathur, Rani Lakshmibai etc. Had those books not been by my side, I would have left the subject of history without knowing of such great men and women, who walked on our land of Bharat. Right now, I do not have the books I studied in schools, but I'm sure that any alumni of D.A.V. (who were schooled there in late 1990s to early 2000s) would agree to it. The students who took up science stream after matriculation would never need to deal with the subject of history again unless their interests pile up. Then it would depend primarily on what sources they pick. At times, there would be books which would designate the revolutionaries as 'terrorists'. For example, Bipan Chandra writes in his book, *India's Struggle for Independence*, 'It is not accidental that nearly all the major new leaders of the revolutionary terrorist politics, for example, Jogesh Chandra Chatterjea, Surya Sen, Jatin Das, Chandrashekhar Azad, Bhagat Singh, Sukhdev, Shiv Varma, Bhagwati Charan Vohra and Jaidev Kapur, had been enthusiastic participants in the non-violent Non-Cooperation Movement.' (Bipan Chandra, 1989) In contrast if one gets a hand on *History of The Freedom Movement in India* by R.C. Majumdar, he would end up giving a completely different view which actually is very close to reality. For heaven's sake, who in India will see Bhagat Singh and allies as terrorists? In whole book, Majumdar has not made opinions about Bhagat Singh and other revolutionaries, but he has just penned out instances which could promote people to make an opinion about revolutionaries (Majumdar, 1962).

2 Class-VI (6th) N.C.E.R.T. Book for History, Chapter 7 (N.C.E.R.T., 2021).

3 Romila Thapar in her book, *Ashoka and the Decline of Mauryas* talks of edicts and inscriptions (Thapar, 1961) while trying to discredit the claim that Ashoka